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Recurrent Neural Network - I



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RNN: Recap

RNNs: Recap

Neural Networks For Sequence Data

1

Definition

Neural networks created to process sequences of data

2

Applications

Used in text generation, translation, forecasting, and speech recognition

3

Key feature

Remembers previous inputs to guide current output

Challenges in Training RNNs

Key Limitations To Be Aware Of

Gradient issues

Vanishing and exploding gradients in backpropagation

Long-term dependencies

Difficulty capturing patterns across many time steps

Overfitting and computation

Prone to overfitting and costly for long sequences

Gated RNN Variants

Popular Improvements On Standard RNNs

LSTM

Manages long-term dependencies using forget, input and output gates

GRU

A lighter version with fewer gates, quicker to train

Usage

LSTM suits complex sequences, GRU suits faster training

Optimisation Techniques

Methods To Improve RNN Training



Gradient clipping

Restricts gradient size to avoid explosion



Batch Normalisation

Normalises activations across batches to stabilise training



Dropout

Randomly removes units during training to reduce overfitting

Best Practices for RNNs

Tips For Effective Training

1. Data Preprocessing

- **Normalise/Standardise Data:** Bring input features to zero mean and unit variance for smoother and more stable training
- **Sequence Padding/Truncation:** Make all sequences the same length using padding for shorter ones or truncation for longer ones. Tools like Keras `pad_sequences()` help with this
- **Remove Outliers:** Detect and manage outliers, especially in time series, to avoid skewed learning and improve model robustness

2. Batching and Sequence Handling

- **Use Time-Major Batches:** Use the format `(sequence_length, batch_size, features)` instead of `(batch_size, sequence_length, features)` for better computational performance
- **Shuffling Data:** Shuffle sequences when they are independent to improve generalisation. For time series, maintain order to preserve temporal patterns
- **Stateful vs. Stateless LSTM:** Choose stateful LSTM when dependencies span across batches. Remember to reset states when moving between unrelated sequences

Best Practices for RNNs

Tips For Effective Training

3. Model Architecture

- **Stacked RNNs:** Use multiple RNN layers (stacked LSTM/GRU) to capture complex patterns. Set `return_sequences=True` for all layers except the last
- **Bidirectional RNNs:** Apply bidirectional wrappers when both past and future context is useful, such as in text processing
- **Dropout Regularisation:** Add dropout (20–50%) between layers to reduce overfitting. For LSTMs/GRUs, use `recurrent_dropout` to regularise recurrent connections

4. Choosing Between LSTM and GRU

- **LSTM:** Better for modelling long-term dependencies, thanks to separate forget, input, and output gates
- **GRU:** Faster to train and works well with smaller datasets or shorter sequences. With fewer gates, it's simpler and less prone to overfitting

Best Practices for RNNs

Tips For Effective Training

Training Tips

- **Learning Rate Scheduling:** Begin with a moderate rate (e.g., 0.001) and use a scheduler like ReduceLROnPlateau to lower it when validation performance stalls.
- **Gradient Clipping:** Apply clipnorm or clipvalue to control exploding gradients, a common issue in RNN training
- **Early Stopping:** Track validation loss and stop training if it fails to improve after a set number of epochs (patience), preventing overfitting and wasted computation

Stock Price Prediction



Stock Price Forecasting

Predicting Future Prices with LSTM and GRU



Predicting stock prices is vital for investors and traders

Uses historical stock data to forecast future closing prices

Employs LSTM and GRU deep learning models

Compares model performance and accuracy on unseen data

Stock Price Prediction

```
# Importing Libraries  
import numpy as np  
import pandas as pd  
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt  
import seaborn as sns  
from sklearn.preprocessing import MinMaxScaler  
from sklearn.metrics import mean_squared_error, mean_absolute_error  
import tensorflow as tf  
from tensorflow.keras.models import Sequential  
from tensorflow.keras.layers import LSTM, GRU, Dense, Dropout  
from tensorflow.keras.optimizers import Adam  
from sklearn.model_selection import train_test_split
```

Stock Price Prediction

```
# Suppress warnings for clean output  
import warnings  
warnings.filterwarnings('ignore')
```

```
# Set random seeds for reproducibility  
np.random.seed(42)  
tf.random.set_seed(42)
```

```
# Problem Statement  
print("Problem Statement: Predict future stock prices using time series data with LSTM and GRU models.")
```

```
# Data Description  
print("\nData Description:")  
print("We are using a stock prices dataset containing 'Date' and 'Close' columns.")  
print("Objective: Predict the closing price for the next day based on historical data.")
```

```
# Step 1: Load the Data  
# Load the dataset and parse the 'Date' column as a datetime object  
df = pd.read_csv('stock_prices.csv', parse_dates=['Date'], index_col='Date')  
df = df[['Close']] # Using only the 'Close' column for forecasting  
print("\nFirst 5 rows of the dataset:")
```

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```
# Step 2: Data Preprocessing  
# Checking for missing values  
print("\nChecking for missing values...")  
print(df.isnull().sum())
```

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```
# Scaling the data between 0 and 1 for better model performance  
scaler = MinMaxScaler(feature_range=(0, 1))  
df['Close'] = scaler.fit_transform(df[['Close']])
```


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```
# Visualizing the scaled data  
plt.figure(figsize=(10, 5))  
plt.plot(df['Close'])  
plt.title('Scaled Stock Prices')  
plt.xlabel('Date')  
plt.ylabel('Normalized Close Price')  
plt.show()
```

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```
# Step 3: Prepare the Data for Time Series Forecasting  
# Function to create sequences of data for model training  
def create_dataset(data, time_step=60):  
    X, y = [], []  
    for i in range(len(data) - time_step - 1):  
        X.append(data[i:(i + time_step), 0])  
        y.append(data[i + time_step, 0])  
    return np.array(X), np.array(y)  
  
# Convert the dataframe to a numpy array  
data = df.values
```

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```
# Split data into training (80%) and testing sets (20%)  
train_size = int(len(data) * 0.8)  
test_size = len(data) - train_size  
train_data, test_data = data[:train_size], data[train_size:]
```

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```
# Create the training and testing datasets using a time step of 60  
time_step = 60  
X_train, y_train = create_dataset(train_data, time_step)  
X_test, y_test = create_dataset(test_data, time_step)  
  
# Reshape data to fit the input format expected by LSTM/GRU models  
X_train = X_train.reshape(X_train.shape[0], X_train.shape[1], 1)  
X_test = X_test.reshape(X_test.shape[0], X_test.shape[1], 1)
```

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Step 4: LSTM Model Implementation

print("\nBuilding and Training the LSTM Model...")

Define the LSTM model

lstm_model = Sequential()

lstm_model.add(LSTM(64, return_sequences=True, input_shape=(time_step, 1)))

lstm_model.add(Dropout(0.2)) # Dropout to prevent overfitting

lstm_model.add(LSTM(32))

lstm_model.add(Dense(1)) # Output layer with one neuron for prediction

lstm_model.compile(optimizer=Adam(learning_rate=0.001), loss='mean_squared_error')

Train the LSTM model

history_lstm = lstm_model.fit(X_train, y_train, epochs=20, batch_size=32,

validation_data=(X_test, y_test), verbose=1)

Stock Price Prediction

```
# Define the GRU model  
gru_model = Sequential()  
gru_model.add(GRU(64, return_sequences=True, input_shape=(time_step, 1)))  
gru_model.add(Dropout(0.2)) # Dropout to prevent overfitting  
gru_model.add(GRU(32))  
gru_model.add(Dense(1)) # Output layer with one neuron for prediction  
gru_model.compile(optimizer=Adam(learning_rate=0.001), loss='mean_squared_error')  
  
# Train the GRU model  
history_gru = gru_model.fit(X_train, y_train, epochs=20, batch_size=32, validation_data=(X_test,  
y_test), verbose=1)
```

Stock Price Prediction

Step 6: Model Evaluation

Function to evaluate and plot the model's performance

```
def evaluate_model(model, X_train, y_train, X_test, y_test, model_name):
```

```
    # Make predictions on training and testing data
```

```
    train_pred = model.predict(X_train)
```

```
    test_pred = model.predict(X_test)
```

```
    # Inverse transform predictions to original scale
```

```
    train_pred = scaler.inverse_transform(train_pred)
```

```
    test_pred = scaler.inverse_transform(test_pred)
```

```
    y_train = scaler.inverse_transform(y_train.reshape(-1, 1))
```

```
    y_test = scaler.inverse_transform(y_test.reshape(-1, 1))
```

```
    # Calculate evaluation metrics: RMSE and MAE
```

```
    train_rmse = np.sqrt(mean_squared_error(y_train, train_pred))
```

```
    test_rmse = np.sqrt(mean_squared_error(y_test, test_pred))
```

```
    train_mae = mean_absolute_error(y_train, train_pred)
```

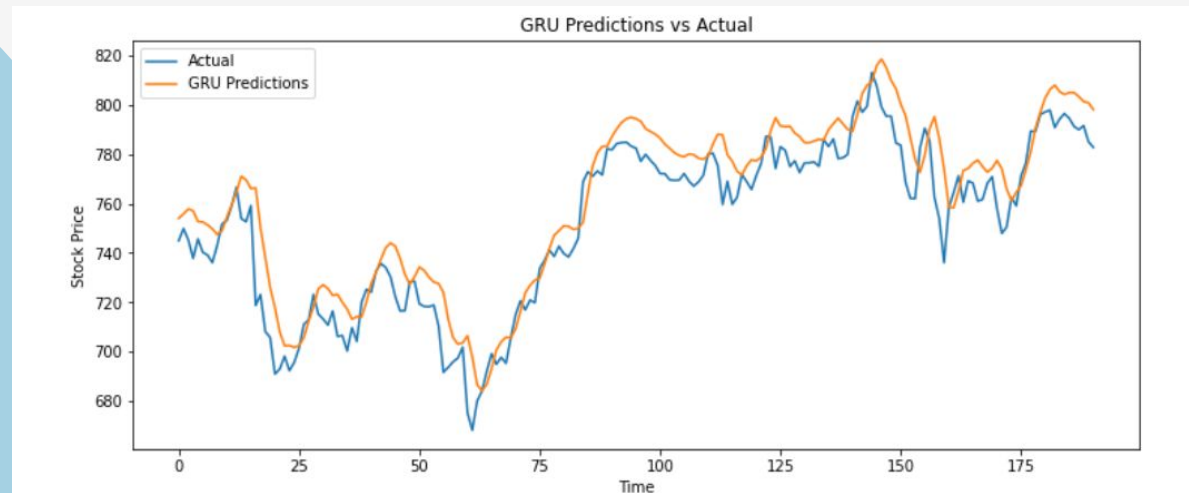
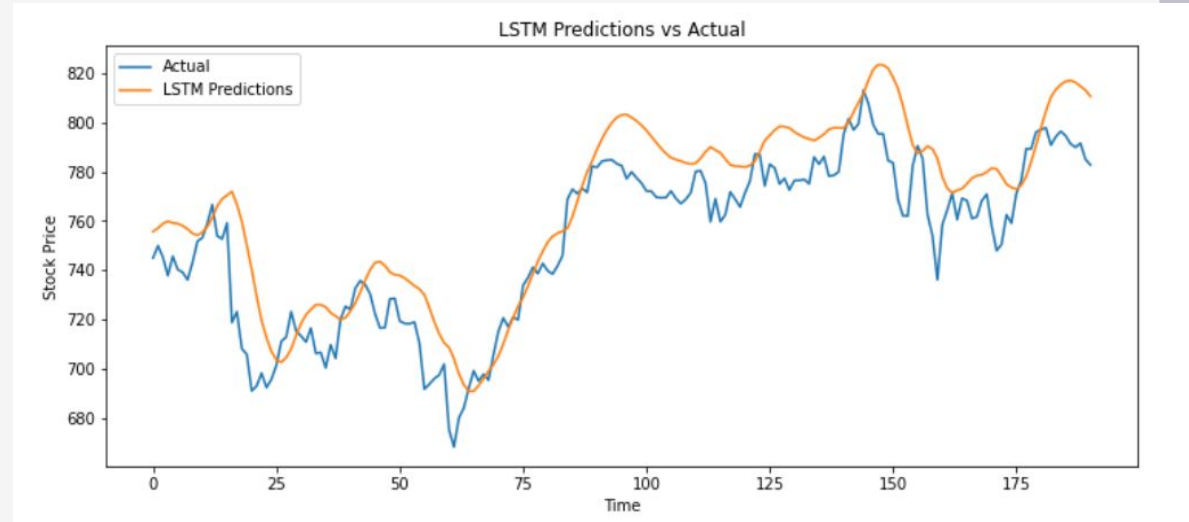
```
    test_mae = mean_absolute_error(y_test, test_pred)
```

Stock Price Prediction

```
print(f"\n{model_name} - Train RMSE: {train_rmse:.4f}, Test RMSE: {test_rmse:.4f}")
print(f"{model_name} - Train MAE: {train_mae:.4f}, Test MAE: {test_mae:.4f}")

# Plotting actual vs predicted values
plt.figure(figsize=(12, 5))
plt.plot(y_test, label='Actual')
plt.plot(test_pred, label=f'{model_name} Predictions')
plt.title(f'{model_name} Predictions vs Actual')
plt.xlabel('Time')
plt.ylabel('Stock Price')
plt.legend()
plt.show()
```


Stock Price Prediction



Stock Price Prediction

```
# Evaluate the LSTM Model  
print("\nEvaluating LSTM Model...")  
evaluate_model(lstm_model, X_train, y_train, X_test, y_test, "LSTM")  
  
# Evaluate the GRU Model  
print("\nEvaluating GRU Model...")  
evaluate_model(gru_model, X_train, y_train, X_test, y_test, "GRU")
```

Q&A Session



Open floor for questions and clarifications.